

PEER INFLUENCE, PERSONALITY TRAITS & SOCIAL STATUS AS DETERMINANTS OF IMPULSIVE ONLINE FASHION BUYING BEHAVIOR

A STUDY ON GEN Z CONSUMERS IN DHAKA

GROUP 4

Term Paper on

Peer Influence, Personality Traits & Social Status as Determinants of Impulsive Online Fashion Buying Behavior Among Dhaka Gen Z Consumers

Buyer Behavior | M401

Submitted to

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Subject: Submission of term paper on **Peer Influence, Personality Traits & Social Status as Determinants of Impulsive Online Fashion Buying Behavior Among Dhaka Gen Z Consumers**.

Dear Sir,

We, Group 04, hereby submit our term paper titled **Peer Influence, Personality Traits & Social Status as Determinants of Impulsive Online Fashion Buying Behavior Among Dhaka Gen Z Consumers** for the **Buyer Behavior** Course (**M401**) at the Institute of Business Administration (IBA), University of Dhaka. Working on this report was both challenging and rewarding in terms of expanding my understanding of the course concepts. This paper is predominantly based on primary research. We have made every effort to meet the specified and sincerely hope that this paper meets your expectations.

We would like to emphasize that this paper was written under your supervision and will not be reproduced or republished without your authorization. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Group 04, BBA 30th

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Wasi Uz Zaman (87)

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Abstract

This research investigates the drivers of impulsive online fashion buying among Generation Z consumers in Dhaka, Bangladesh, by examining the relationship between external social pressures and internal psychological states. The study finds that while peer influence and social status create background pressure, personality traits serve as the primary internal drivers that shape an individual's behavioral traits, such as the tendency to act without forethought or seek emotional gratification. Quantitative analysis of 160 participants revealed that specific personality indices were the only significant predictors of impulsive buying, whereas peer influence and perceived social status did not show a direct significant effect on the immediate purchase response. Interestingly, a significant difference in impulsive behavior was found between genders, with male respondents in this sample exhibiting higher impulsivity levels than females. Furthermore, although higher impulsivity is significantly associated with post-purchase regret, many consumers engage in **rationalized impulsivity**—cognitively framing unplanned purchases as necessary or personally meaningful to mitigate negative emotions. The report concludes that impulsive fashion consumption in Dhaka is a cyclical process of mood regulation, and it recommends that marketers focus on creating mood-lifting content and providing post-purchase validation to neutralize consumer guilt.

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Introduction

Rationale

This research empirically investigates the determinants of impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Gen Z consumers in Dhaka, specifically testing the joint and individual impacts of peer influence, perceived social status, and personality traits. A central premise of the study is that personality traits (such as extraversion, neuroticism, or trait impulsivity) function as the core internal drivers that shape an individual's behavioral traits, such as the tendency to act without forethought or seek immediate emotional gratification. The study primarily seeks to clarify how external social pressures, amplified by social-media platforms like Facebook and Instagram, are filtered through internal psychological states to trigger unplanned purchases. Furthermore, the rationale extends to evaluating the emotional consequences of these behaviors, such as post-purchase regret, and assessing how demographic variables like gender, etc.) moderate these impulsive tendencies. Ultimately, this paper addresses a critical gap in literature by focusing on a digitally native cohort in a local market that uniquely blends rapid digital adoption with cultural collectivism.

Background

Gen Z consumers in Dhaka, born between 1997 and 2012, represent a digitally native cohort heavily engaged with social media platforms like Facebook, Instagram, and TikTok, where fashion trends spread rapidly. This group drives much of Bangladesh's expanding e-commerce sector with surging online fashion. This surge is partly due to platforms offering swift and convenient purchases amongst limited physical retail shops and partly due to the inherent impulsive characteristic traits in the Gen Z population. Studies show peer influence, personality traits like extraversion, and desires for social status significantly trigger impulsive buying in similar young demographics across South Asia. This paper aims to elaborate on the impact and extent of these traits specifically in the Gen Z population living in Dhaka.

Scope of the Study

This research targets Gen Z (ages 13–28) in Dhaka actively using online platforms for fashion, focusing on peer influence, and social status perceptions as predictors of

impulsivity. It employs quantitative surveys for local validity, excluding offline buying or other product categories. Findings apply to urban Bangladeshi marketers and educators, with limitations to self-reported data from accessible student-heavy samples.

Problem Statement

Dhaka's Gen Z consumers frequently succumb to impulsive online fashion buys influenced by peers via social media, personality-driven tendencies, and status aspirations, leading to potential overspending without clear empirical insights into these mechanisms. Despite e-commerce penetration among youth rising, only 10% of internet users shop online, signaling untapped potential marred by unexamined behavioral drivers. (Chowdhury, 2020) The core issue is the absence of targeted data on how these factors interplay in Dhaka, hindering effective interventions for sustainable consumption.

Aims & Objectives

Research Aim

The primary aim of this study is to **critically investigate the determinants of impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Generation Z consumers in Dhaka**. Specifically, the study seeks to analyze the collective influence of external social pressures (peer influence and social status) and internal personality traits, while examining how demographic factors and shopping platforms moderate these behaviors.

Research Objectives

Primary Objectives

- To examine the impact of peer influence and perceived social status on the frequency of impulsive online fashion purchases.
- To evaluate the role of specific personality traits (such as high impulsivity or hedonic motives) in driving unplanned fashion buying behavior.

Secondary Objectives

- To analyze the inter-relationship between peer influence and social status, specifically determining if peer pressure intensifies the need for status signaling.
- To assess the variations in impulsive buying behavior based on situational factors, including the choice of social commerce platform and preferred payment methods.
- To compare impulsive buying tendencies and status-seeking motives across different demographic groups, specifically focusing on gender differences and the impact of monthly financial allowance.
- To determine the relationship between high impulsivity and the psychological outcome of post-purchase regret.

Hypotheses to be Tested

After careful evaluation of the literature review, the research gaps, and the scope of the study, the following hypotheses are created and tested (alternative hypotheses are stated):

1. Peer Influence, Perceived Social Status, and Behavioral Traits jointly and significantly predict impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.
2. Specific Behavioral Traits (shaped by personality traits) have a significant effect on impulse buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.
3. Peer influence has a significant effect on impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.
4. Perceived social status has a significant effect on impuse buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.
5. Peer Influence has a significant effect on perceived social status pressure among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.
6. Impulsive online fashion buying behavior differs significantly based on the primary social commerce platform used by Dhaka Gen Z consumers.
7. Higher impulsivity is significantly associated with post - purchase regrets among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.
8. There is a significant association between preferred payment method and impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Gen Z consumers.

9. Dhaka Gen Z consumers with higher monthly personal allowance exhibits significantly higher impulsive buying behavior.
10. There is a significant difference in impulsive online fashion buying behavior between male and female Gen Z consumers.

Assumptions & Limitations

Assumptions

- **Honesty in Response:** The study assumes that respondents provided truthful and accurate responses regarding their financial allowances and impulsive habits, despite the sensitive nature of questions regarding “post-purchase regret” and “status signaling”.
- **Fashion as a High-Involvement Category:** It is assumed that fashion represents a uniquely high-involvement category for Generation Z, where purchases are driven by identity and social projection rather than purely functional needs.
- **Digital Literacy:** The study assumes that the target sample (Gen Z in Dhaka) possesses a baseline level of digital literacy and is familiar with social commerce mechanics (live selling, influencer posts, etc.) as a standard part of their consumption lifestyle.

Limitations

Methodological Limitations

1. **Sampling Bias (Non-Random/Convenience Sampling):** The reliance on non-probability purposive sampling limits generalizability, as the sample may not accurately reflect the broader target population of all Bangladeshi youths.
2. **Self-Selection Bias:** Voluntary participation introduces potential bias, as individuals who choose to respond may possess traits (such as higher interest in fashion) or behaviors that differ from the general population.
3. **Self-Reported Data & Social Desirability:** The study relies on self-reported metrics, which are subject to inherent bias. Respondents may have altered their answers to align with perceived social norms, such as underreporting “regret” or “status seeking”, rather than reporting their actual behavior, potentially compromising data accuracy.

4. **Cross-Sectional Design:** The study utilizes a cross-sectional design, capturing data at a single point in time. This prevents the assessment of evolving behaviors and limits the ability to establish strict causal relationships between variables.

Scope and Contextual Limitations

- **Geographical Concentration:** The study is exclusively focused on Dhaka City. Consequently, the findings regarding social status and digital payments may not reflect the behavior of Gen Z consumers in rural or semi-urban areas of Bangladesh, where internet penetration and social norms differ.
- **Exclusion of Economic Factors:** The research focuses on psychological and social determinants (Peers, Personality, Status). It largely excludes external economic factors such as inflation, price sensitivity, or logistics quality, which also play significant roles in purchase decisions.

Literature Review

Since the 1980s, the body of research on buyer behavior has shifted significantly, focusing on deeper consumer traits and behavioral dimensions that drive purchasing decisions rather than simply analyzing product characteristics (Chowdhury, 2020). This literature review will systematically examine the foundational concepts and empirical evidence supporting the selection of key variables in this study—*impulsive buying*, *fashion*, *Dhaka*, *Generation Z*, *peer pressure*, *personality*, and *social status*—and explain them through the theoretical lens of buyer and consumer behavior. This review will lay the groundwork for empirical testing of the Gen Z market in Dhaka by describing the causal links and existing inconsistencies across various global and regional contexts.

Impulsive Online Buying Behavior

Online Buying

The process of searching for, choosing, evaluating, and finally purchasing goods and services via internet-based channels such as e-commerce websites, social media shops, and mobile apps, with digital payment and home delivery or pickup, is called ***online buying***. Its unique selling point is that it offers consumers the added

convenience of shopping and browsing products from the comfort of their homes. Moreover, the high availability of information, the option of personalization, algorithmic recommendations, and user reviews help people make more informed and better decisions.

Impulsive Buying

In consumer behavior literature, ***impulsive buying*** *is usually defined as a sudden, strong, and irresistible urge to buy something immediately, with little or no prior planning and limited cognitive deliberation* (Rani, 2024). Such purchases are driven solely by strong emotions, such as excitement, pleasure, anxiety, and, at times, nervousness. In most cases, they deviate from the rational decision-making process. Thus, they may later lead to post-purchase conflict or regret.

Distinguishing Related Online Buying Types

- **Unplanned Buying:** *Refers to any purchase not specifically intended before entering a store or platform and often triggered by reminders or recognition of a future need* (Nandi, 2018). It differs from impulse buying in one slight nuance: some unplanned purchases still involve a quick but functional evaluation, with a relatively rational justification.
- **Compulsive Buying:** Unlike impulsive buying, compulsive buying involves not just shopping on a whim but also a compulsive need to buy products that are often unnecessary. Consumers who engage in shopping behavior do so to improve their mood, self-image, social approval, and sometimes, stress levels (Hartney, 2024).
- **Rational Buying:** Rational buying involves a deliberate, targeted information search, comparison of alternatives, and evaluation of price. As the name suggests, it is a consistent approach to rationalism and utility maximization, and it follows a rigorous rational decision-making process.
- **Necessary Buying:** The purchase of day-to-day necessities such as food staples, hygiene products, etc., where the primary motive is functionality and convenience. Even when unplanned, these purchases are justified by necessity rather than impulsive or compulsive behavior or pleasure-seeking.

Why Fashion is Uniquely Impulsive

Fashion is something that appeals to one's self-identity, image, and social perception, and is a striking symbol of social status. It depends on a person's mind, whims, and surroundings. Some people identify fashion with self, and some others with society. However, in reality, fashion is an inseparable blend of the two. It combines the self with society and ultimately produces a product that stands out. Which is precisely why fashion does not adhere to any rules; instead, it makes up its own. Furthermore, following that train of thought, it is safe to say that if something follows its own rules, it is, by the very definition, impulsive.

Why Online Platforms Amplify Impulsivity

As discussed earlier, online interfaces are engineered for frictionless purchasing. Combining this convenience with an inherently impulsive and tempting concept like fashion, online platforms basically play with consumers' emotions, showing them the latest fashion pieces they can buy with just one click. Not only that, but these e-commerce platforms also deploy promotions and scarcity cues that trigger urgency: **flash sales**, **countdown timers**, **limited-stock labels**, and **pop-ups** showing other people's purchases, with the intention to create pressure to **buy now** before missing out.

Peer Influence as a Determinant

Peer influence strongly correlates with impulsive purchase behavior, indicating that friends and social circles can significantly impact shopping decisions. According to researchers, ***peer influence*** *is the strong need to fit in and be accepted by one's social group, which ultimately leads people to give in to peer pressure* (Alawiah & Hayu, 2025). As per Sheu et al. (2017), ***peer influence*** *is the extent to which others influence one's attitudes, beliefs, and opinions*. Furthermore, peer pressure is an effect that, either directly or indirectly, promotes changes in attitudes, values, or behaviors to conform to what is deemed socially acceptable within a group (Gulati, 2017). With peer support, pressure might be more aggressive and manipulative, causing young adults to make snap decisions (Thürmer et al., 2020).

Peer Conformity & The Need to Belong

- **Social Signaling:** Adolescents and young adults strive for social acceptance and popularity, and they use purchases to demonstrate affiliation and signal

that they **fit in** (K. M. Nguyen et al., 2025). Purchasing the same product as friends allows people to avoid feeling socially excluded or **left out** (Alawiah & Hayu, 2025).

- **Cultural Context:** Gen Z places great importance on peer evaluation and social acceptance in collectivist societies such as Bangladesh and Indonesia. This dramatically increases the pressure to fit in and influences their purchasing decisions (Chowdhury, 2020).
- **Dominant Factor:** Research shows that peer pressure is often the most influential factor in impulsive shopping behavior on social commerce platforms, making it critical for marketers aiming to reach young consumers to understand this mechanism (Alawiah & Hayu, 2025).

The Role of Social Comparison & Joy

- **Amplified Monitoring:** Social media allows individuals to actively monitor their peers' possessions and curate their peers' styles and behavior, a practice referred to as social media stalking, resulting in awareness of perceived superior achievements or assets (K. M. Nguyen et al., 2025).
- **Envy as Motivation:** Theodore Roosevelt once said, *"Comparison is the thief of joy*." Constant comparison increases feelings of inadequacy or envy. Although envy is a negative emotion, it can drive immediate impulse purchases to bridge the perceived gap between one's own status and that of one's peers. Purchasing products that your peers want provides emotional satisfaction and social validation (K. M. Nguyen et al., 2025).
- **Digital Reach:** The impulse to buy is often deepened by social dynamics enabled by online platforms (K. M. Nguyen et al., 2025). The ease of use of social media amplifies peer influence, transforming friends and social networks on platforms such as Instagram and YouTube into powerful, modern references (Islam, 2025; Ngo et al., 2024).

The Digital Reference Group: Influencer & Celebrity Endorsement

In the online world, peer influence is extended significantly by digital figures known as **influencers** or **micro-celebrities**, who serve as powerful new reference groups (Otegbade, 2025; Shetu, 2023). This type of influence is frequently more persuasive

than traditional celebrity endorsements because Gen Z perceives digital celebrities as genuine, approachable, and reliable (Alawiah & Hayu, 2025; Shefi, 2025).

- **Mechanism of Influence:** Digital celebrity and influencer posts, like peer pressure, have a significant impact on Gen Z consumers' intention to search for and engage in frequent online purchase behavior in cities such as Dhaka (Shetu, 2023). This effectiveness stems from followers prioritizing the influencer's perceived credibility, often over their formal expertise or objective product need (Alawiah & Hayu, 2025).
- **Emotional Trigger:** These figures' social influence has a significant positive impact on consumer arousal and pleasure (Ngo et al., 2024). This emotional stimulation is an important mechanism for driving impulsive purchases because perceived authenticity and sincerity from the influencer foster trust, which directly activates impulsive buying tendencies (Shefi, 2025).

Personality Traits as Determinant

Personality traits act as core internal drivers that predispose consumers to impulsive buying by shaping how they process peer cues and online stimuli. Literature highlights three primary frameworks: the Big Five, Trait Impulsivity, and MBTI.

The Big Five Model

Research consistently links specific traits to digital vulnerability. **Extraversion** drives impulsivity through a desire for social visibility and stimulation. **Neuroticism** is a positive predictor, and often, shopping serves as a mood-regulation strategy for stress. Conversely, **conscientiousness**, characterized by discipline, curbs impulsivity, helping consumers resist the urge to buy during flash sales. **Openness** and **agreeableness** show mixed patterns, driving novelty-seeking and fashion conformity, respectively (Ahmed et al., 2023; Djafarova & Bowes, 2021; Huang et al., 2024; Hutapea & Christabel, 2024; Purwaningtyas et al., 2025; Tandom et al., 2023).

Trait Impulsivity

Defined as acting without forethought, trait impulsivity is a proximal driver of unplanned purchases. Components such as **motor impulsivity** (acting on the spot) and **non-planning impulsivity** (weak future orientation) are exacerbated by e-commerce features. Frictionless tools, such as one-click checkouts, allow consumers to instantly

convert momentary urges into purchases (Chaudhary et al., 2025; Hawkins & Mothersbaugh, n.d.; Rodrigues et al., 2021).

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) Dimensions

MBTI factors significantly influence emotional regulation in shopping. **Extraverts** are drawn to social, gamified triggers (Roos & Kazemi, 2022; Zhang & Shi, 2022). People with **intuitive** traits favor novelty and display higher shopping frequency (Huang et al., 2024; Roos & Kazemi, 2022). Besides, people who are **feeling** types are more sensitive to emotional narratives and FOMO (Arruda Filho & Oliveira, 2023; Handayani & Haryadi, 2022), while **perceiving** types, preferring spontaneity, exhibit weak planning skills linked to higher impulsivity (Ahmed et al., 2023; Aquino & Lins, 2023).

Personality & Behavioral Traits

In consumer behavior, personality traits, such as extraversion or trait impulsivity, act as the core internal drivers that shape an individual's specific behavioral traits. These traits dictate a person's tendency to act without forethought or seek immediate emotional gratification, especially through retail therapy. Ultimately, this internal processing transforms momentary excitement or social pressure into the physical response of an impulsive purchase. ***Retail therapy*** *refers to the practice of purchasing items with the primary goal of improving one's mood or alleviating negative emotions like stress and boredom* (Baker et al., 2024; Rozman & Hashim, 2023; Shehzadi et al., 2016).

Mindfulness & Self-Control

Low mindfulness and poor self-control are linked to Problematic Internet Use (**PIU**). This dysfunctional usage increases exposure to marketing cues while reducing cognitive resources for decision-making. PIU acts as a mediating mechanism, translating self-regulatory deficits into impulsive buying, highlighting that psychological factors are as critical as situational stimuli in the digital fashion context (Chen et al., 2022; Rose & Dhandayudham, 2014; Vihari et al., 2022).

Perceived Social Status as Determinant

Actual Social Class & Stratifications

Society is divided into **six** social stratifications (Hawkins & Mothersbaugh, n.d.):

1. The Upper-Upper Class or Country-Club Establishment
2. The Lower-Upper Class or New Wealth
3. The Upper-Middle Class or Achieving Professionals
4. The Lower-Middle Class or Faithful Followers
5. The Upper-Lower Class or Security-Minded Majority
6. The Lower-Lower Class or Rock Bottom

Perceived Social Class & Stratifications

Perceived social class *refers to a consumer's subjective sense of others' social class in a society, based on factors such as income, lifestyle, and education*. For Gen Z consumers in Dhaka, this perceived status is not static; instead, it is actively managed and aspirational, through online fashion consumption (Chowdhury, 2020).

The Upward Pull Strategy

The Upward Pull Strategy creates a psychological feedback loop. When middle-class consumers see upper-class consumption patterns detailed on social media, they internalize a gap in their own social status. This status anxiety, that is, the discomfort of feeling **below** and behind others, triggers a sense of urgency to purchase items that promise immediate status elevation, at least psychologically (Hawkins & Mothersbaugh, n.d.).

Because this anxiety is tied to social comparison and peer evaluation, impulsive buying becomes a coping mechanism. Now, buying provides immediate symbolic relief and the hope of enhanced social standing, even if rationalism would suggest saving or more careful purchase decisions (Petrescu et al., 2025).

The Highly Tempting "Reel Economy"

Fashion reels on Instagram and TikTok strongly shape online buying patterns by showcasing trendy, luxurious fashion pieces, demonstrating outfit styling, and promoting **follow-the-trend** hashtags that encourage viewers to imitate these looks (Djafarova & Bowes, 2021). As social proof, they display likes, comments, shares, and influencer endorsements, making featured fashion items seem more desirable (Aswanto & Mayangsari, 2019). Because reels often include shoppable tags, direct links, and time-limited offers, they create a seamless path from inspiration to checkout,

encouraging more impulsive purchases (Alawiah & Hayu, 2025; T.-B.-N. Nguyen et al., 2025).

Impulsivity Across Generations

Consumer research commonly distinguishes four broad age groups: Baby Boomers (born roughly mid-1940s to mid-1960s), Generation X (mid-1960s to early 1980s), Millennials or Generation Y (early 1980s to late 1990s), and Generation Z (late 1990s onward). These cohorts grew up in different media and market environments, which shape their attitudes toward brands, technology, and risk in consumption (Karmakar et al., 2023).

Generation-Driven Patterns in Online Consumption

- **Impulsive Tendencies Among Older Cohorts (Generation X and Baby Boomers):** Older cohorts, particularly Generation X and Baby Boomers, typically exhibit lower levels of impulsive and compulsive buying than younger generations, and their purchases are more constrained by budget consciousness and risk aversion (Karmakar et al., 2023). Older consumers tend to prioritize value, quality, and functional benefits over trendiness, are less immersed in social media environments that amplify FOMO and rely more on planned shopping and comparison. Their overall attitude toward consumption is more deliberate and cautious, resulting in comparatively weaker impulsive tendencies than those observed among Gen Z and younger Millennials.
- **Impulsive Tendencies Among Younger Cohorts (Gen Z and Younger Millennials):** Evidence on compulsive and impulsive buying shows a consistent age gradient—younger consumers tend to report higher levels of compulsive or obsessive-compulsive buying than older adults, especially for brand- and fashion-intensive categories. Studies that link FOMO with brand passion find that younger cohorts experience stronger FOMO, develop more intense, often obsessive, brand passion, and are therefore more prone to uurgency-driven less controlled purchases (University of Portsmouth, 2024).

Personality-driven Patterns in Online Consumption

Generational differences in impulsive online consumption can also be understood in terms of personality and online social interaction. Traits such as extraversion, openness, agreeableness, and conscientiousness positively affect online purchase

decisions and post-purchase engagement, whereas neuroticism negatively affects them (Huang & Yu, 2024). When these traits combine with continuous online social interaction—liking, sharing, joining groups, and following brand communities—consumers engage in what Huang and Yu call "deep online consumption behavior," characterized by complex decision-making, high engagement, and more unpredictable purchase patterns. For Gen Z and younger Millennials, who spend more time in such social-commerce spaces, this deep engagement tends to amplify impulsive attitudes. They respond quickly to recommendations, FOMO-driven prompts, and social proof, often prioritizing excitement and self-expression over careful deliberation.

By contrast, Generation X and Baby Boomers are generally less embedded in these interaction-heavy environments and show higher emphasis on value, planning, and risk reduction, which translates into more stable, deliberative online consumption and comparatively weaker impulsive tendencies (Nyrhinen et al., 2024).

Why Gen Z is the Focus

Gen Z is central to consumer research because they represent a demographic and cultural shift that fundamentally alters market dynamics. They are the most significant global cohort (32% globally; 40% in Bangladesh) and command significant current and future purchasing power (Otegbade, 2025). As **"mobile-first" digital native**, they seamlessly blend online and offline lives, driving digital economy trends (Ahmed, 2025).

Factors of Unique Susceptibility

Gen Z displays distinct susceptibility to impulse buying compared to Millennials and Gen X due to the following convergence of factors:

- **Heightened Impulsivity:** According to Fontanilla et al. (2025), 41% of Gen Z identify as impulsive shoppers (vs. 34% of Millennials and 32% of Gen X). Driven by hedonic (pleasure-seeking) rather than utilitarian (practical) motivations, and by a desire for instant gratification, they use 24/7 access to regulate mood immediately (T.-B.-N. Nguyen et al., 2025).
- **"Authentic" Influence:** Skeptical of corporate ads, Gen Z favors *authentic* micro-celebrities and User-Generated Content (UGC) (Otegbade, 2025; Shetu,

2023). Parasocial relationships with influencers and peer reviews reduce purchase uncertainty and trigger desire (T.-B.-N. Nguyen et al., 2025).

- **FOMO & Social Validation:** Scarcity promotions and peer activity trigger Fear of Missing Out (**FOMO**), overriding rational decision-making (Amin et al., 2024). Furthermore, narcissistic traits drive consumption as a means of identity expression and social status signaling (Elgeka et al., 2025).
- **Algorithmic Vulnerability:** Social platforms exploit Gen Z through personalized algorithms that target latent desires. The cohort is highly responsive to visual, interactive stimuli (e.g., short videos), which amplify the urge to buy (T.-B.-N. Nguyen et al., 2025; Shetu, 2023).
- **Financial Literacy Gaps:** Many in this cohort struggle to distinguish *needs* from *wants*. Frictionless digital payments (e.g., *Buy Now, Pay Later*) reduce the *pain of paying*, facilitating impulsive consumption despite lower financial literacy (Elgeka et al., 2025; Yee & Zainal, 2025).

Impulsivity Across the Geographical Border

Globally, Gen Z is regarded as the most impulsive generation compared to its predecessors. According to research, **41%** of Gen Z customers make impulse purchases, compared to 34% of Millennials and 32% of Generation X (Alawiah & Hayu, 2025; Mijoska et al., 2023; T.-B.-N. Nguyen et al., 2025). If we go through the studies conducted on some of the countries:

Global Situation

In a study of young urban users, 49.8% acknowledged to “often” buying things online spontaneously, while 18.4% said they “always” do so. Only 7.2% stated that they never buy spontaneously. Not only that, approximately 43.2% of young respondents purchase online “often,” using platforms like Facebook and Shopee for apparel and accessories. (Suyanto et al., 2025).

Bangladesh

Though a very limited number of studies have been conducted on the Bangladeshi market, the studies indicate a higher frequency of spontaneous behavior among Bangladeshi youths, particularly in urban hubs like Dhaka. Bangladeshi consumers demonstrate strong purchasing affinity, with 69% agreeing with the statement, “It

seems like every year, there are more things I want to buy"—a rate higher than in many other Southeast Asian nations (Chowdhury, 2020; Rahman et al., 2018).

United States

US Gen Z customers are particularly impulsive, often driven by higher discretionary income than in underdeveloped countries. American teenagers are almost **80%** more likely to make impulse purchases online (Otegbade, 2025). **54%** of US shoppers reported making impulse purchases worth more than $100 (T.-B.-N. Nguyen et al., 2025).

China

China's Generation Z is defined by "on-the-go" mobile consumption. As per Nguyen et al. (2025), Chinese Gen Z is the most spontaneous, with **47%** making impulse purchases while on the road (mobile shopping). The Asia Pacific region, led by China, accounts for the majority of global internet purchases, indicating that this demographic drives high transaction volumes (Rahman et al., 2018).

Indonesia

Like Bangladeshi youth, Indonesian youth also have a high rate of unexpected purchases. According to a poll, **67%** of Indonesia's young customers make spontaneous purchases of items not on their shopping lists (Alawiah & Hayu, 2025). Indonesia has the highest e-commerce usage rate in the world, with **37.7%** of respondents regularly purchasing online (Ahmed et al., 2023).

North Macedonia

While there is a tendency of impulsivity in North Macedonia, financial restrictions limit behavior in this developing economy. Although Gen Z navigates the internet intuitively, their impulse buying ratings were lower (below neutral). This shows that, while they desire items, their financial dependence on their parents limits their ability to act on these impulses in comparison to their Western counterparts (Mijoska et al., 2023).

The Dhaka Context: Digital Natives & Affluent Growth

Dhaka represents a highly dynamic consumer market in Bangladesh, fueled primarily by an expanding Middle-Affluent Class (**MAC**) (Chowdhury, 2020). This demographic cohort is a primary focus for online retail, particularly since apparel and accessories are among the most popular products purchased online (Rahman et al., 2018).

Crucially, Bangladeshi consumers generally have a strong purchasing affinity, meaning they are inclined to buy (Chowdhury, 2020). Gen Z in this market has a significantly higher tendency towards Online Impulsive Buying Behavior (**OIBB**) than older generations, relying on online platforms to save time and access a wide range of products (Rahman et al., 2018). Dhaka dominates the country's online shopping traffic, influence, and social norm.

In a culturally conservative and family-centric society like Bangladesh, external social influence is arguably the most dominant factor driving impulsive purchases among Gen Z consumers.

- **Conformity & Acceptance:** Peer evaluation and the innate desire for social acceptance are essential, amplifying pressure to conform to group expectations (Aswanto & Mayangsari, 2019). When it comes to fashion or branded clothing, Bangladeshi female students, for example, are heavily influenced by their peer groups (Islam, 2025).
- **Online Reference Groups:** The online ecosystem formalizes friends and followers (also known as social network connections) as key reference groups (Islam, 2025). As a result, social media stalking—the act of closely monitoring peers' posts to track lifestyle possessions—becomes more common, stimulating peer influence and the chain reaction that leads to impulse purchases (K. M. Nguyen et al., 2025).
- **Social Marketing Triggers:** This social environment means Gen Z consumers are highly responsive to content such as User-Generated Content (**UGC**) and micro-celebrity posts, viewing them as credible endorsements that prompt online searches for products seen on platforms such as Facebook and TikTok (Alawiah & Hayu, 2025; Rahman et al., 2018; Shetu, 2023).

Social Status & Image Projection

Consumers use purchases, particularly highly visible items such as fashion, to signal their social identity and manage their public image (Aswanto & Mayangsari, 2019). Although research on older cohorts indicates that impulse buying is closely related to income-based social status, this is not the case among younger Gen Z consumers (Islam, 2025). For this generation, peer influence often translates into pressure to engage in specific purchasing behaviors to maintain perceived status or avoid social

exclusion. This dynamic, however, is complicated by society's inherent conservatism. Research suggests that female Gen Z users may engage in self-censorship online to manage tensions caused by peer pressure while adhering to social norms (Ahmed, 2025).

Personality & Internal Triggers

While some studies involving Bangladeshi consumers, particularly those spanning generations, have found no significant link between demographic factors (such as age and gender) and impulse tendency, internal psychological states are still important (Chowdhury, 2020). Impulse Buying Tendency (**IBT**), defined as the enduring tendency to react spontaneously to stimuli, is an important precursor to OIBB. Furthermore, emotional responses and established behavioral patterns are shown to influence Gen Z's proclivity toward spontaneous purchases significantly (Fontanilla et al., 2025).

Gaps in Literature

Despite extensive research on consumer behavior, a critical review reveals several significant gaps in understanding Gen Z's impulsive fashion consumption, which this study aims to address.

1. **There is a lack of integrated behavioral models for Digital Native Gen Z**: Existing studies typically examine peer influence, personality traits, and social status in isolation. There is a scarcity of research that synthesizes these variables into a single, cohesive framework. Specifically, the S-O-R model is rarely applied to the intersection of social comparison and trait impulsivity within the "Organism" component for younger cohorts.
2. **A significant gap exists in Geography and Culture:** Most of the research focuses on Western markets or established Asian economies. There is limited empirical evidence specifically in Dhaka, Bangladesh—a market that uniquely blends cultural conservatism with rapid digital adoption. Consequently, the interaction between traditional collectivist norms and modern digital peer pressure in this region remains under-theorized.
3. **The distinction between "Objective" and "Perceived" status is often overlooked:** Prior literature prioritizes objective socioeconomic class (income) as a driver of consumption. However, for Gen Z, *perceived* and *aspirational*

social status—fueled by the reel economy of social media—is likely a stronger predictor. This study addresses this gap by focusing on status perception rather than economic reality.

4. **Fashion-specific analysis is insufficient:** Many studies treat "online buying" as a generic activity. This research argues that fashion is uniquely impulsive due to its high visibility and role in identity signaling, requiring a specialized lens that generic e-commerce studies fail to provide.

Theoretical Framework

The Hawkins, Best & Coney Model

The core theoretical framework in the literature review is prepared keeping the model as the prime focus:

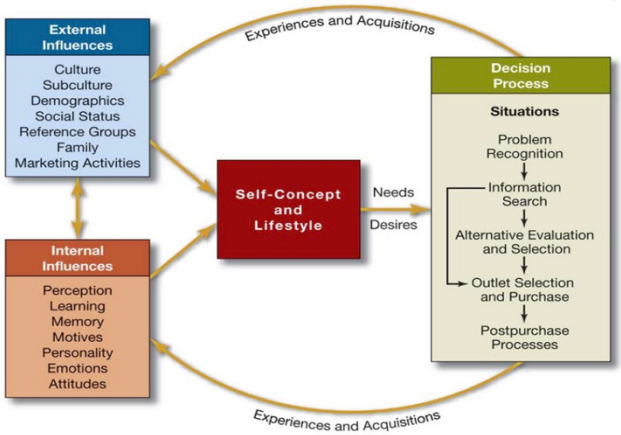


Figure 1. The Hawkins, Best & Coney Model

The S-O-R Framework

The theoretical foundation of this study integrates classic and contemporary consumer behavior paradigms to explain the convergence of external pressures and internal psychological drives. The overarching structure rests on the Stimulus–Organism–Response (**SOR**) Framework. In this model, digital and social factors (peers, status) act as environmental stimuli, personality traits serve as the internal organism processing these inputs, and impulsive online fashion buying manifests as the behavioral response.

Social Stimuli: Peer Influence & Social Status

The environmental stimuli driving consumers are grounded in social influence and social impact perspectives. These theories posit that individuals conform to group

norms to ensure acceptance and maintain social identity. **Reference Groups** play a pivotal role here, providing informational influence (data on what is trendy) and normative influence (pressure to conform) (Hawkins & Mothersbaugh, n.d.; *Peer Influence on Consumer Behavior*, 2025). For adolescents and youth, peers replace parents as the primary reference group. In the hyper-connected context of Dhaka, social media amplifies this by turning "likes" and shares into immediate validation, reducing the perceived risk of impulsive decisions. Furthermore, adopter categories are relevant, as consumers with high impulse tendencies often strive to be **Innovators** and **Early Adopters** to maintain opinion leadership within their circles.

Parallel to peer influence is the drive for status, explained by **Social Comparison Theory**. Individuals evaluate their worth by comparing themselves to relevant others, particularly in visible domains like fashion. **Upward Comparison** with affluent or influential peers on social media generates feelings of deficiency, motivating compensatory consumption. The **Upward Pull** strategy suggests that as consumers aspire to a higher social class, they engage in impulsive buying of trendy items to signal upward mobility. Consequently, **perceived social status** serves both as a cognitive evaluation and a motivational driver. The online "highlight reel economy" exposes Gen-Z to aspirational imagery, increasing the pressure to manage impressions through impulsive purchases (Petrescu et al., 2025; Sun & Guo, 2017).

The Organism: Personality & Internal Processing

Within the S-O-R framework, the "organism" represents the internal processing of these stimuli. Personality traits, specifically the **Big Five** model, predispose individuals to specific emotional responses (Ahmed et al., 2023). These broad traits create a baseline processing style, while **trait impulsivity** dictates the speed of decision-making. Trait impulsivity determines whether momentary affective states dominate reflective control, making some consumers more likely to convert peer pressure into immediate action without deliberation (Chaudhary et al., 2025; Sokić, 2020).

Internal psychological drivers further explain the urgency of these purchases. **McGuire's Psychological Motives**—specifically the Need for Assertion (seeking admiration) and the Need for Ego-Defense (protecting identity)—drive consumers to buy impulsively to assert style or mitigate the Fear Of Missing Out (**FOMO**). Additionally, **Emotion arousal** acts as a product benefit; the hedonic nature of

browsing provides immediate excitement, serving as an emotional lift or stress reliever (Chang et al., 2011; Hawkins & Mothersbaugh, n.d.).

From Intention to Behavioral Response

Finally, the Theory of Planned Behavior **(TPB)** helps explain how these internal states translate into action. TPB suggests attitudes, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control drive behavior. For Gen-Z in Dhaka, strong peer norms (people like me expect me to be trendy) and favorable attitudes toward fast fashion weaken perceived control (Sutisna & Handra, 2022; Tang et al., 2021).

In conclusion, the social impact and social comparison theories explain the sensitivity of Dhaka's Gen-Z to external stimuli. The S-O-R framework operationalizes this, showing how Personality and Trait Impulsivity filter these stimuli, while TPB and McGuire's Motives clarify the psychological mechanisms that ultimately trigger impulsive online fashion buying.

Conceptual Framework

Based on the theoretical underpinnings discussed above, this study operationalizes the S-O-R model to examine impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Gen-Z consumers in Dhaka.

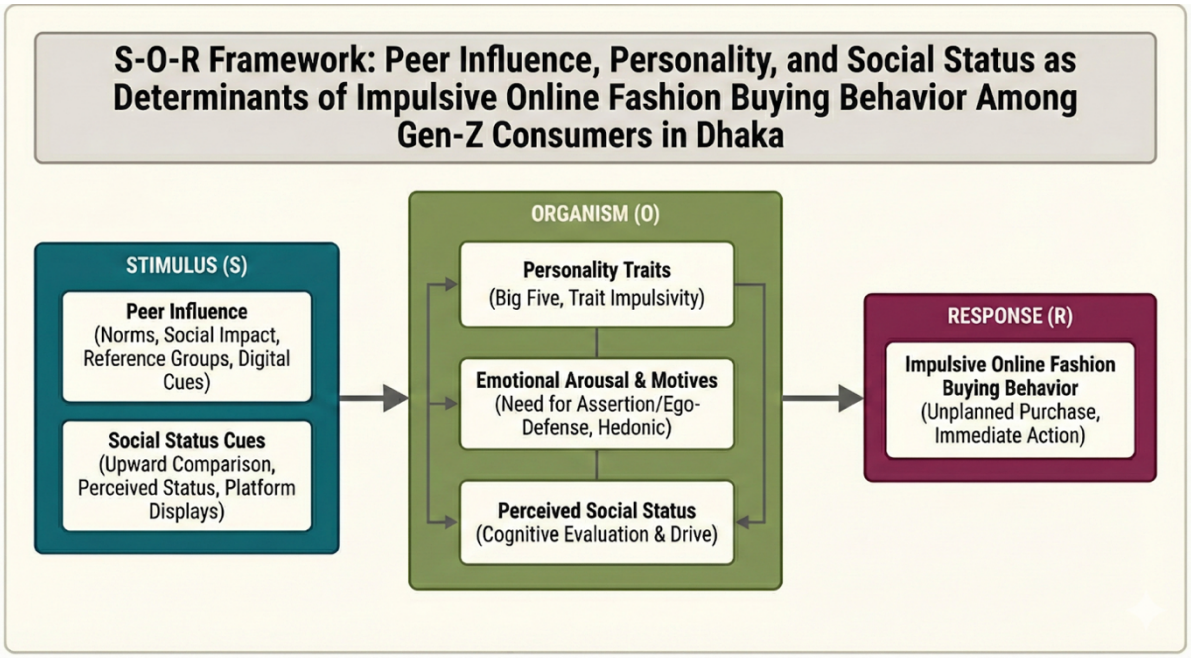


Figure 02. *Conceptual Framework of the Study*

As illustrated in Figure 2, the framework proposes that external social stimulus—specifically **Peer Influence** and **Social Status Cues**—do not directly cause impulsive

buying but are first filtered through the consumer's internal psychological state (the Organism). This internal processing consists of **personality traits** (Big Five, Impulsivity), **emotional arousal**, and **perceived social status**. The framework posits that the interplay between external social pressures and internal personality characteristics ultimately triggers **impulsive online fashion buying**.

Methodology

Research Design

This study employs a **sequential, exploratory, mixed-methods research design**. The rationale for adopting this **two-phase** approach is to first explore the unique, context-specific behavioral drivers of Generation Z in Dhaka before subjecting them to empirical statistical testing.

Research Phases

The research is structured into **two** distinct but integrated phases:

1. **Phase 01: Exploratory Qualitative Phase**

The study begins with a qualitative exploration to identify key variables and recurring themes regarding fashion consumption among Gen Z in Dhaka. Given that existing frameworks may not fully capture the nuances of the local social commerce environment, this phase serves as a foundation for contextualizing the research and refining the conceptual model. The insights gathered here directly inform the development of the research hypotheses and the construction of the survey instrument.

2. **Phase 02: Descriptive Quantitative Phase**

Following the exploratory phase, the study transitions to a quantitative approach, which serves as the primary method of investigation. This phase employs a **descriptive and causal research design** to statistically measure the relationships between the identified independent variables (Peer Influence, Personality, and Social Status) and the dependent variable (Impulsive Buying Behavior).

Time Horizon

A **Cross-Sectional Design** is employed, involving data collection at a single point in time. This approach captures a snapshot of the current behavioral patterns and

psychological states of the target demographic without the need for longitudinal observation.

Sampling

Target Population & Characteristics

The target population of this study comprises Generation Z consumers residing in Dhaka, Bangladesh, specifically those who have made online fashion purchases. Gen Z, generally defined as individuals born between 1997 and 2012, represents a digitally native cohort with high social media engagement and increasing purchasing power, and they are particularly relevant for examining impulsive online buying behavior (Aripradono & Silvina, 2023; Priya & Agrawal, 2024). This study focuses on Gen-Z individuals aged **18–27 years**, as this group is more likely to be university students or young professionals who have independent purchasing power and active participation in online fashion consumption. Hence, they will provide insights into impulsive purchasing behaviors during a formative period of consumer identity development (Ngo et al., 2024).

Sampling Method

A **non-probability sampling method**, specifically purposive sampling, is employed to select participants who meet the defined criteria for Generation Z consumers in Dhaka and have experience with online fashion purchases. This method is chosen to ensure that the selected sample accurately reflects the characteristics of the target population, thereby increasing the relevance and applicability of the research findings to the specific demographic under investigation (Shetu, 2023).

Sample size

We used **Cochran's formula** for determining an appropriate sample size. It is important to note that Cochran's formula is used in probability sampling. We used it here only to get a rough idea about what the sample size should be.

$$\boldsymbol{n = \frac{Z^2 p(1-p)}{e^2}}$$

Here,

Z = Z-value corresponding to a 90% confidence level (**1.645**)

p = Estimated population proportion (**0.5**), used due to the absence of prior population estimates

e = Margin of error (**6.5%**)

To calculate the sample size with a 90% confidence level and a 6.5% margin of error,

$$n = \frac{(1.645)^2 \times 0.5(1 - 0.5)}{(0.065)^2}$$

$$or, n = \frac{2.706025 \times 0.25}{0.004225}$$

$$or, n = 160.12$$

$$or, n \approx 160$$

The sample size is approximately **160 participants**.

Data Collection Methods

Qualitative Data Collection

Primary data for our research was conducted via semi-structured interviews and Focus Group Discussions (**FGD**) with Gen Z consumers based in Dhaka. In this case, open-ended questions were used to encourage detailed answers, helping us understand the extent of enthusiasm, impulsivity, excitement, or the lack of it regarding online fashion purchases.

- **Semi-structured Interviews:** Initial insights was collected through at least **five** short semi-structured interviews with a small sample of Gen Z consumers (aged 18–27) who regularly purchase fashion items online. The interview guide focused on **three** core themes:
    1. Social media usage in relation to fashion (e.g., reliance on Instagram, Facebook, TikTok for trend discovery)
    2. Peer interaction during the purchase journey (e.g., sending links to friends and seeking approval, and reacting to friends' posts)
    3. Emotional states before, during, and after online purchases (e.g., excitement, mood improvement, regret).
- **Focus Group Discussion:** To further validate and contextualize the interview themes, **two** focus group discussions were conducted with Gen Z fashion shoppers in Dhaka. Participants were grouped to reflect variation in gender and

income levels, and the discussion guide used open-ended questions about collective shopping norms, the role of social media content (e.g., reels, influencer hauls), and perceptions of **fitting in** or **looking upper class** through fashion. The analysis of these discussions yielded a more nuanced perspective on the topic and eventually help us design survey questions that capture the exact behavioral patterns of our respondents.

Quantitative Data Collection

Quantitative data were collected through a structured online survey comprising demographic and behavioral sections, designed to support group comparisons and hypothesis testing. All attitudinal items used a five-point Likert scale (1 = "Strongly Disagree" to 5 = "Strongly Agree") to allow the use of parametric statistical techniques. The survey was distributed to the target demographic via **Google Forms**. This method ensures the questionnaire reaches a broader audience and makes data collection easier. The questionnaire can be founded in the **appendix**.

Data Analysis Methods

After collecting all the necessary data, it was analyzed using the required methods to generate insights and validate hypotheses. This depicted and visualized the research's patterns and trends, which may provide critical insights into general fashion purchasing behavior in Dhaka, particularly among Gen Z customers.

Quantitative Data Analysis

The necessary stages of quantitative data collection are:

- **Software:** For quantitative data collection, **R** was used based on convenience, level of analysis, and availability.
- **Statistical Tests:** Based on the types of data, these are some of the statistical tests that may be used are Chi-Square test, Pearson & Spearman Correlation analysis, Independent Samples t-test, One-Way ANOVA, Kurskal Wallis test, Simple & Multiple Linear Regressions, Proportion test, etc. These analytical tools and statistical tests revealed links, trends, and underlying structures in the data, ensuring statistical accuracy and relevant findings, and validating hypotheses to reach a scientific conclusion.

Qualitative Data Analysis

The responses from the interview and focus group discussions was reviewed to identify recurring themes. Some potential themes that emerged from these qualitative data include impulsivity, social acceptance, affordability, convenience, confidence in social settings, and following trends. Working with these themes made this paper more robust by pinpointing and analyzing how factors such as peer pressure, perceived social status, and personality traits influence the impulsive buying behavior—particularly for fashion items—of Gen Z consumers in Dhaka city.

Scale Reliability & Composite Index Construction

Before hypothesis testing, the internal consistency of the multi-item constructs were assessed using **Cronbach's alpha** to ensure the questions within each topic can be grouped together and can reasonably be combined into a single score. The reliability results were:

Topics	Questions	raw_alpha	r.drop
Peer Pressure	7	**0.6470662**	0.2541838
	8		0.5011407
	9		0.4202448
	10		0.4766579
	11		0.3616768
Perceived Social Status	12	**0.6948744**	0.5354463
	13		0.5346129
	14		0.576165
	15		0.2858166
Personality Traits	16	**0.7958247**	0.5559457
	17		0.520126
	18		0.6423354
	19		0.5961334
	20		0.6224576
	21		0.3792497
	22		0.3560246

Item–total correlations (**r.drop**) were also reviewed to see whether each question aligned with the overall construct; most items showed acceptable positive alignment,

with a few weaker items (lower r.drop values) indicating they contribute less strongly to the shared concept. Overall, the reliability was **moderate** for Peer Pressure (0.65) and Social Status (0.69) and **good** for Personality Traits (0.80), so composite indices were created for each construct. Specifically, responses for each set of items were combined into a composite index (typically by taking the mean across the relevant questions), producing a single numeric score per respondent for Peer Pressure, Social Status, and Personality Traits. These composite indices reduce noise from individual items, keep the measure on the same scale (e.g., 1–5), and make the variables directly usable in the main analyses (e.g., correlations, regressions, ANOVA/t-tests) as predictors or outcomes in hypothesis testing.

Ethical Considerations

Ethical safeguards were incorporated at all stages of the study to protect participants' rights and privacy:

- Before beginning the questionnaire, respondents were presented with a brief paragraph outlining the research's academic purpose, the voluntary nature of participation, the approximate time required, and their right to withdraw at any time without penalty.
- No identifying personal information (e.g., full name, phone number, or student ID) was collected, and all responses were stored in aggregate form so that individual participants could not be traced, ensuring anonymity and confidentiality.
- Participants were informed that the data would be used only for academic analysis and reporting, that results would be presented in grouped form (e.g., averages by gender or income bracket), and that there were no direct risks or financial incentives associated with participation, thereby minimizing potential coercion or harm.

Findings & Analysis

Every finding of the study can be categorized into **six** themes. The themes are organized with the hypotheses, quantitative findings, and qualitative findings below:

1. Internal Drivers of Impulsive Buying

Hypotheses Testing & Results

Hypothesis 01: This hypothesis aims to find the relationship between the core independent variables (peer influence, perceived social status, personality traits) and impulsive buying. The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$\boldsymbol{H_0}: \textit{Peer Influence, Perceived Social Status, and Behavioral Traits does not jointly and significantly predict impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.}$$

$$\boldsymbol{H_A}: \textit{Peer Influence, Perceived Social Status, and Behavioral Traits jointly and significantly predict impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.}$$

As the independent variables (Peer Influence Index, Social Status Index, and Personality Index) are numeric composite scores and the dependent variable (Impulsive Buying Index) is also a numeric composite score, a **two-tailed multiple linear regression** was conducted to examine whether the null hypothesis can be rejected.

Descriptive Statistics (H01)

Variable	Mean	Std. Deviation	N
dependent_variable_index	2.497	1.081	160
peer_influence_index	2.959	0.843	160
social_status_index	2.783	0.860	160
personality_index	2.759	0.903	160

Regression Results (H01): Peer Influence, Social Status, Personality, & Impulsive Buying

Predictor	B	95% CI (Low)	95% CI (High)	p-value
(Intercept)	3.28	2.52, 4.04	4.04	<0.001
peer_influence_index	0.072	-0.143, 0.287	0.287	0.509
social_status_index	-0.099	-0.308, 0.110	0.110	0.353
personality_index	-0.261	-0.457, -0.065	-0.065	0.009
R^2	0.056			
Adjusted R^2	0.038			
Statistic	3.07			

Predictor	B	95% CI (Low)	95% CI (High)	p-value
p-value	**0.030**			
Sigma	1.06			

Abbreviation: CI = Confidence Interval

The test reveals that the p-value to be **0.030** which is less than or equal to the α (0.05) but explained a very small portion (5.6%) of variance. Which means, holding other variables constant, at least one predictor (personality traits) is related to the dependent variable whereas peer influence and perceived social status were not significant. So, we can hereby ***reject*** the null that *peer influence, perceived social status, and personality traits does not jointly and significantly predict impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers*, i.e., and accept the alternative that *they do jointly and significantly predicts*.

Hypothesis 02: This hypothesis aims to find the relationship between behavioral traits (shaped by personality traits) and impulsive buying. The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$\boldsymbol{H_0}: Specific\ Behavioral\ Traits\ have\ no\ significant\ effect\ on\ impulse\ buying\ behvaior\ among\ Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers.$$

$$\boldsymbol{H_A}: Specific\ Behavioral\ Traits\ have\ a\ significant\ effect\ on\ impuse\ buying\ behavior\ among\ Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers.$$

As both the independent variable (Behavioral Traits Index) and dependent variable (Impulsive Buying Index) are numeric composite scores, a **simple linear regression** was performed to determine whether the null can be rejected.

Descriptive Statistics (H02)

Variable	Mean	Std. Deviation	N
personality_index	2.758929	0.9025396	160
dependent_variable_index	2.496875	1.0808465	160

Regression Results (H02): Behavioral Traits & Impulsive Buying

Predictor	B	95% CI (Low)	95% CI (High)	p-value
(Intercept)	3.23	2.70, 3.76	3.76	<0.001

Predictor	B	95% CI (Low)	95% CI (High)	p-value
personality_index	-0.266	-0.450, -0.083	-0.083	0.005
R^2	0.049			
Adjusted R^2	0.043			
Statistic	8.21			
p-value	**0.005**			
Sigma	1.06			

Abbreviation: CI = Confidence Interval

The test reveals that the p-value to be **0.005** which is less than or equal to the α (0.05). So, we can hereby ***reject*** the null that *specific behavioral traits* (shaped by personality traits) *have no significant effect on impulse buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers*, i.e., and accept the alternative that *specific behavioral traits* (shaped by personality traits) *have a significant effect on impulse buying*.

Qualitative Analysis

Several respondents described their purchasing behavior as spontaneous yet carefully justified as need-based or personally meaningful. This suggests a form of rationalized impulsivity, where purchases are made without extensive planning but are cognitively framed as necessary or wanted, thereby minimizing post-purchase regret.

"I buy things spontaneously, however those 'buys' are never something I don't need. So I never regret what I buy"

"I only buy stuff I actually need or want"

These responses help explain why impulsive buying tendencies in the sample were not strongly associated with feelings of regret, despite evidence of spontaneous purchasing behavior.

Inference

Overall, internal factors appear to explain impulsive buying more consistently than external social influences in this sample. The multiple regression model was statistically significant, but **personality traits** (which ultimately affects impulsive purchasing by shaping behavioral tendencies) were the only significant predictor, while peer influence and perceived social status were not. This implies that impulsive buying among Dhaka Gen Z consumers is driven more by individual tendencies (e.g.,

emotional or spontaneous buying patterns) than by social pressure alone. However, the explained variance remains small, suggesting impulsive buying is likely shaped by additional situational and contextual factors beyond the measured constructs.

2. Social Influence & Status Pressure

Hypotheses Testing & Results

Hypothesis 03: This hypothesis aims to find the relationship between peer influence and impulsive buying. The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$\boldsymbol{H_0}: \textit{Peer influence has no significant effect on impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.}$$

$$\boldsymbol{H_A}: \textit{Peer influence has a significant effect on impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.}$$

As both the independent variable (Peer Influence Index) and dependent variable (Impulsive Buying Index) are numeric composite scores, a **simple linear regression** was performed to determine whether the null can be rejected.

Descriptive Statistics (H03)

Variable	Mean	Std. Deviation	N
peer_influence_index	2.958750	0.8432035	160
dependent_variable_index	2.496875	1.0808465	160

Regression Results (H03): Peer Influence & Impulsive Buying

Predictor	B	95% CI (Low)	95% CI (High)	p-value
(Intercept)	2.63	2.01, 3.25	3.25	<0.001
peer_influence_index	-0.045	-0.247, 0.156	0.156	0.657
R^2	0.001			
Adjusted R^2	-0.005			
Statistic	0.198			
p-value	**0.7**			
Sigma	1.08			

Abbreviation: CI = Confidence Interval

The test reveals that the p-value to be **0.7** which is higher than the α (0.05). So, we ***cannot reject*** the null that *peer influence has no significant effect on impulse buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers*.

Hypothesis 04: This hypothesis aims to find the relationship between perceived social status and impulsive buying. The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$\boldsymbol{H_0}: Perceived\ social\ status\ has\ no\ significant\ effect\ on\ impulse\ buying\ behavior\ among\ Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers.$$

$$\boldsymbol{H_A}: Perceived\ social\ status\ has\ a\ significant\ effect\ on\ impuse\ buying\ behavior\ among\ Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers.$$

As both the independent variable (Perceived Social Status Index) and dependent variable (Impulsive Buying Index) are numeric composite scores, a **simple linear regression** was performed to determine whether the null can be rejected.

Descriptive Statistics (H04)

Variable	Mean	Std. Deviation	N
social_status_index	2.782812	0.8597032	160
dependent_variable_index	2.496875	1.0808465	160

Regression Results (H04): Social Status & Impulsive Buying

Predictor	B	95% CI (Low)	95% CI (High)	p-value
(Intercept)	2.91	2.34, 3.48	3.48	<0.001
social_status_index	-0.148	-0.344, 0.048	0.048	0.139
R^2	0.014			
Adjusted R^2	0.008			
Statistic	2.21			
p-value	**0.14**			
Sigma	1.08			

Abbreviation: CI = Confidence Interval

The test reveals that the p-value to be **0.14** which is higher than the α (0.05). So, we ***cannot reject*** the null that *perceived social status has no significant effect on impulse buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers*.

Hypothesis 05: This hypothesis aims to find the relationship between peer influence and social status pressure. The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$\boldsymbol{H_0}: Peer\ Influence\ has\ no\ significant\ effect\ on\ perceived\ social\ status\ pressure\ among\ Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers.$$

$$\boldsymbol{H_A}: Peer\ Influence\ has\ a\ significant\ effect\ on\ perceived\ social\ status\ pressure\ among\ Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers.$$

As both the independent variable (Peer Influence Index) and dependent variable (Perceived Social Status Index) are numeric composite scores, a **simple linear regression** was performed to determine whether the null can be rejected.

Descriptive Statistics (H05)

Variable	Mean	Std. Deviation	N
peer_influence_index	2.958750	0.8432035	160
social_status_index	2.782812	0.8597032	160

Regression Results (H05): Peer Influence & Social Status Pressure

Predictor	**B**	**95% CI (Low)**	**95% CI (High)**	**p-value**
(Intercept)	1.76	1.30, 2.22	2.22	<0.001
peer_influence_index	0.346	0.195, 0.497	0.497	<0.001
R^2	0.115			
Adjusted R^2	0.110			
Statistic	20.6			
p-value	**<0.001**			
Sigma	0.811			

Abbreviation: CI = Confidence Interval

The test reveals that the p-value to be less than **0.001** which is less than or equal to the α (0.05). So, we can hereby ***reject*** the null that *peer influence has no significant effect on perceived social status pressure among Dhaka Gen Z consumers. among Dhaka Gen Z consumers*, i.e., and accept the alternative that *peer influence has a significant effect*.

Qualitative Analysis

While peer influence was hypothesized to directly affect impulsive buying behavior, qualitative responses suggest that social influence among Gen Z operates through more indirect and culturally embedded mechanisms rather than explicit peer validation. Several respondents distinguished between interpersonal pressure from peers and a broader culture of overconsumption driven by social media exposure.

> *"I don't think it's the validation that comes from peers that impact impulse buying. It's mostly the overconsumption culture that social media created"*

This distinction indicates that the pressure to consume may be structural and cultural in nature, shaped by pervasive digital norms rather than direct encouragement or approval from peers. Such dynamics offer a plausible explanation for the non-significant direct effect of peer influence observed in the regression analysis, despite its theoretical relevance.

Fashion was also repeatedly described as a marker of social evaluation and symbolic status among Gen Z respondents. However, perceived social status appeared to influence behavior indirectly, operating through social comparison and internalized feelings of inferiority rather than immediate purchase decisions.

> *"It's common among gen zs to judge others by their fashion sense… if someone's more fashionable, they automatically become cooler"*

> *"I feel inferior amongst people with better fashion sense than me… This puts me in a constant pressure to buy better clothes even though I have more than enough clothes"*

These responses suggest that perceived social status exerts psychological pressure that may not translate directly into impulsive purchasing but instead contributes to a latent sense of inadequacy and consumption-oriented mindset. As such, the influence of social status may be diffused and internalized, which could limit its direct measurability in quantitative models while still shaping broader consumption attitudes.

Inference

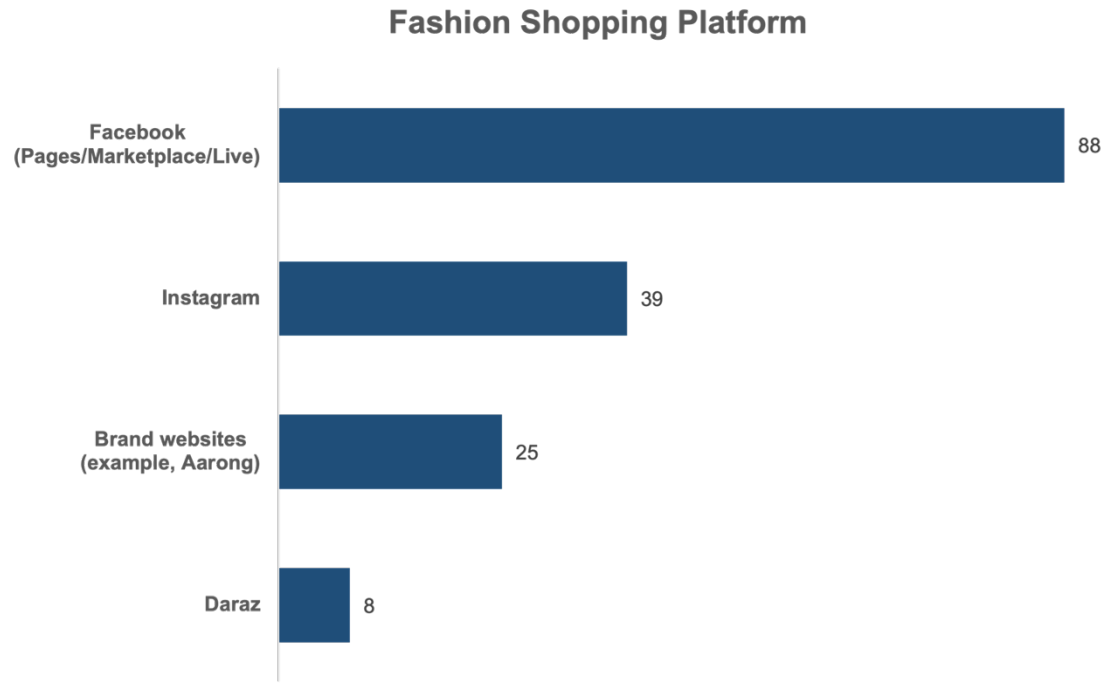
Findings suggest that social influence operates more as a background pressure than as a direct, standalone driver of impulsive buying. Perceived social status did not

significantly predict impulsive buying in the regression results, indicating that status motivation alone may not translate into spontaneous purchases for this sample. Instead, social forces may shape attitudes, identity concerns, and perceived expectations, which can interact with individual traits and situational triggers before affecting buying behavior. This supports interpreting social influence as an indirect pathway rather than a guaranteed cause of impulsive purchases.

3. Platform Environment & Shopping Context

Survey Context

The strongest platform preference is clearly **Facebook**, which reflects Dhaka's social-commerce reality where Live selling and Marketplace browsing dominate fashion purchases. Instagram holds a strong second position, while Daraz and brand apps/websites remain secondary. This indicates impulsive buying triggers are likely happening more on "social-first" platforms than structured e-commerce sites.



Hypothesis Testing & Results

Hypothesis 06: This hypothesis aims to find the relationship between the platform used and impulse buying. The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$\boldsymbol{H_0}: \textit{Impulsive online fashion buying behavior does not differ significantly based on the primary social commerce platform used by Dhaka Gen Z consumers.}$$

$$H_A: Impulsive\ online\ fashion\ buying\ behavior\ differs\ significantly\ based\ on\ the\ primary\ social\ commerce\ platform\ used\ by\ Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers.$$

As the independent variable (Primary Platform Used) is categorical and the dependent variable (Impulsive Buying Index) is a numeric composite score, and because group sizes are extremely uneven with TikTok having 0 responses, a **Kruskal–Wallis test** (non-parametric, two-tailed) was conducted to examine whether the null hypothesis can be rejected.

Descriptive Statistics (H06)

Platform (Q6)	N	Mean	Std. Deviation
Brand websites (example, Aarong)	25	2.840	1.214
Daraz	8	2.812	1.067
Facebook (Pages/Marketplace/Live)	88	2.352	1.020
Instagram	39	2.538	1.103

Kruskal–Wallis Test (H06): Platform Used & Impulsive Buying Index

Test	Chi-square	df	p-value
Kruskal–Wallis	4.001	3	**0.261**

The test reveals that the p-value to be **0.261** which is higher than the α (0.05). So, we ***cannot reject*** the null that *impulsive online fashion buying behavior does not differ significantly based on the primary social commerce platform used by Dhaka Gen Z consumers*.

Qualitative Analysis

When asked, several participants perceived physical stores as more conducive to impulsive purchases due to immediacy and sensory engagement, while online shopping was seen as more deliberate and constrained.

"Personally, store purchases are more impulsive than online purchases"

"However, I prefer physical shopping"

"The main hurdle when shopping online is the lack of option of inspecting the quality of the fabric and whether it fits my size"

These insights provide qualitative support for the relatively weaker and inconsistent relationship observed between online exposure and impulsive buying behavior.

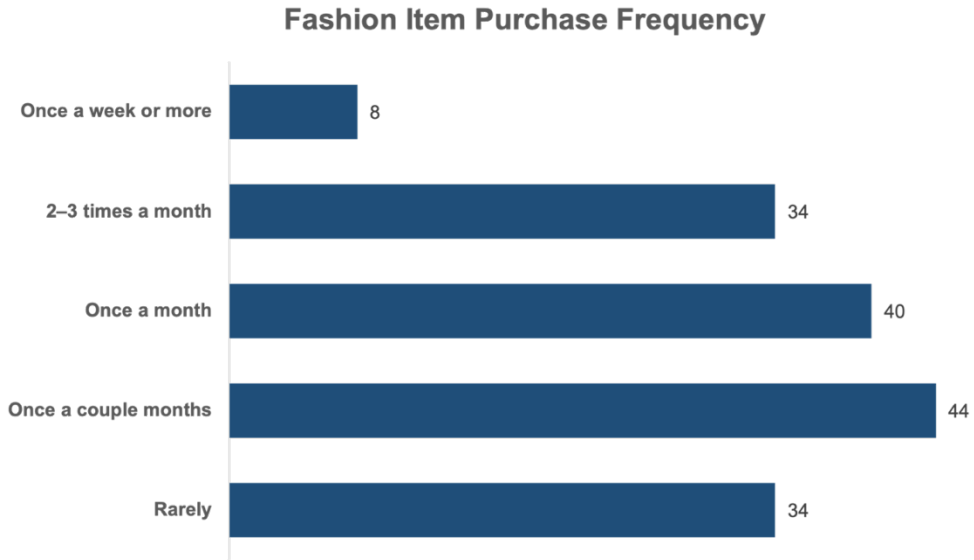
Inference

Platform differences appear to function more as contextual boundaries than as a decisive driver of impulsive buying. While social commerce environments (e.g., Facebook-/Instagram-style shopping) can increase exposure to fashion content, the qualitative responses suggest that many consumers experience online shopping as more deliberate than physical stores due to reduced sensory immediacy and greater time to reconsider. As a result, platform may shape how impulsivity is expressed (browsing, temptation, delay) rather than consistently changing impulsive buying levels across groups.

4. Post-Purchase Outcomes & Rationalizations

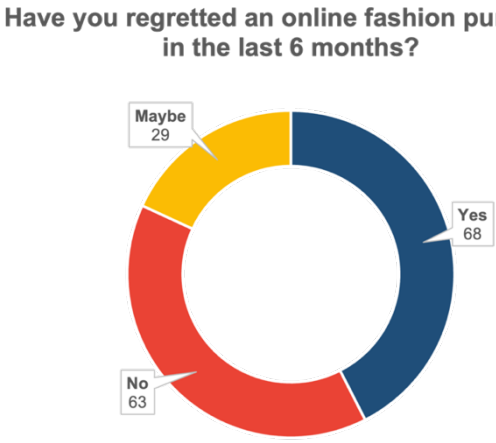
Survey Findings

Most respondents shop online for fashion occasionally—**once every couple of months (44)** or once a month (40)—while only a small minority buy weekly or more. This suggests online fashion buying is a periodic habit for most Gen Z consumers, with heavy shopping concentrated in a smaller segment.

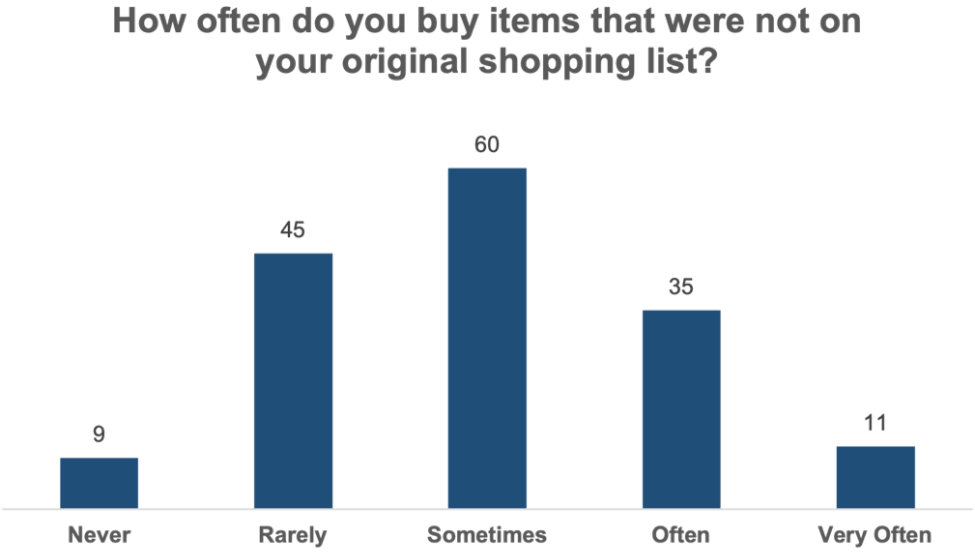


Regret is nearly split between Yes and No, showing that impulsive fashion buying has a **real emotional consequence** among Dhaka Gen Z consumers. Even the “Maybe” responses suggest uncertainty and mixed feelings, indicating that buyers often

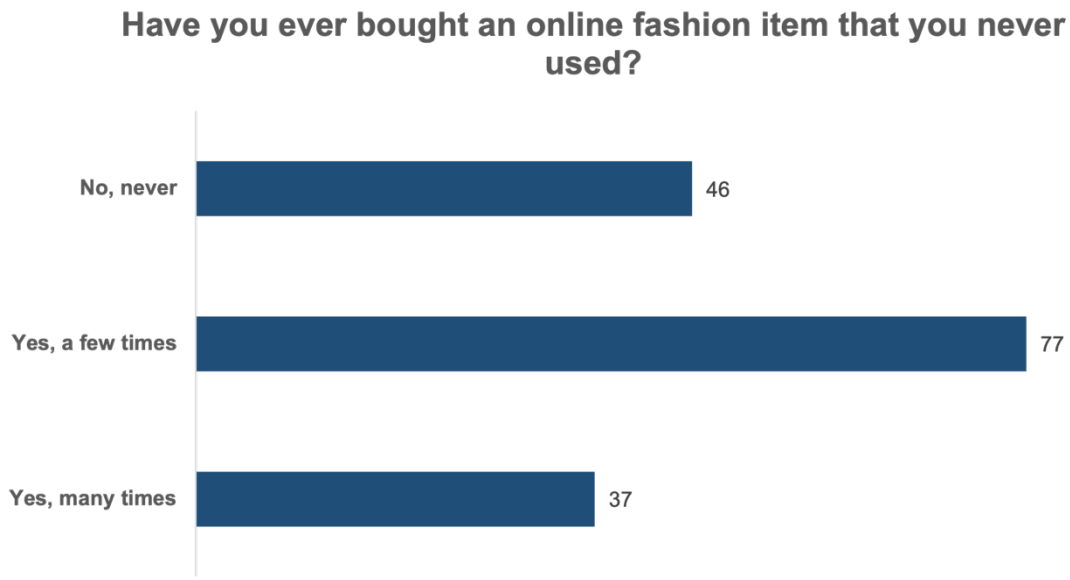
rationalize purchases after the fact, even when the purchase may not have been fully planned or necessary.



in case of sudden purchases, most respondents fall within **Rarely–Sometimes**, meaning impulse buying exists but is not extreme for the majority. However, the presence of a sizeable “Often” group suggests a meaningful segment of Gen Z consumers frequently buys unplanned fashion items, supporting the relevance of psychological and social drivers in this market.



Finally, a strong proportion of respondents admit purchasing fashion items they never ended up using—at least **a few times**. This is a key “post-impulse” signal and supports the idea that online impulsive fashion buying is not just about spending, but also about emotional purchasing and short-term excitement that does not always translate into real usage value.



Hypothesis Testing & Results

Hypothesis 07: This hypothesis aims to find the relationship between impulsivity and post-purchase regret. The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$\boldsymbol{H_0}: Higher\ impulsivity\ is\ not\ significantly\ associated\ with\ post-purchase\ regrets\ among\ Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers.$$

$$\boldsymbol{H_A}: Higher\ impulsivity\ is\ significantly\ associated\ with\ post-purchase\ regrets\ among\ Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers.$$

As the independent variable (Post-Purchase) is categorical and the dependent variable (Impulsivity) is a numeric composite score, a **one-way ANOVA (two-tailed)** was conducted to test whether the null hypothesis can be rejected.

Descriptive Statistics (H07)

Regret Group (Q25)	N	Mean	Std. Deviation
No	63	2.383220	0.7815455
Maybe	29	3.059113	0.8255374
Yes	68	2.978992	0.9285352

Levene's Test (H07): Homogeneity of Variance

F value	p-value	df	df.residual
1.035	**0.358**	2	157

ANOVA Table (H05): Post-Purchase Regret & Impulsivity

term	df	Sum Sq	Mean Sq	F value	p-value
q25	2	14.799	7.400	10.127	**0**
Residuals	157	114.719	0.731		

Post-hoc Tukey HSD (H05): Pairwise Group Comparisons

term	Comparison	Diff	95% CI (Low)	95% CI (High)	p-adj
q25	Yes-No	0.596	0.242	0.949	0.000
q25	Maybe-No	0.676	0.222	1.130	0.002
q25	Yes-Maybe	-0.080	-0.529	0.368	0.906

The test reveals that the p-value to be less than **0.001** which is less than or equal to the α (0.05). So, we can hereby ***reject*** the null that *higher impulsivity is not significantly associated with post-purchase regrets among Dhaka Gen Z consumers*, i.e., and accept the alternative that *higher impulsivity is significantly associated*.

Qualitative Analysis

Although impulsive buying is often associated with post-purchase regret, qualitative responses indicate that impulsivity among Gen Z consumers does not necessarily translate into negative emotional outcomes. Several respondents described their purchases as spontaneous yet internally justified, framing such decisions as aligned with personal needs or preferences rather than as irrational consumption.

"I buy things spontaneously however those 'buys' are never something I don't need. So I never regret what I buy"

"I only buy stuff I actually need or want"

These responses suggest that impulsive buying may be accompanied by cognitive rationalization, which reduces feelings of regret even when purchases are unplanned. This insight provides contextual support for the observed variation in regret across respondents and helps explain why the presence of unused items does not uniformly correspond to negative post-purchase emotions. As such, impulsivity in this context reinforces the distinction between behavioral spontaneity and emotional dissatisfaction, offering an explanation for the mixed results related to regret observed in the quantitative analysis.

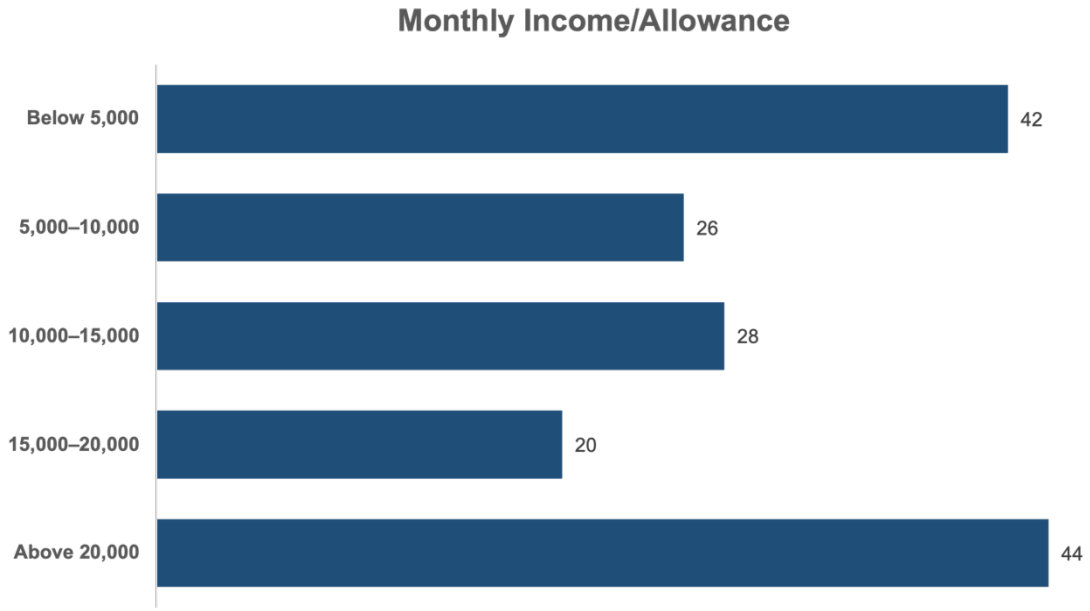
Inference

Post-purchase outcomes indicate that impulsive buying does not always translate into regret because many consumers rationalize purchases as need-based or personally justified. Qualitative responses show a pattern of **rationalized impulsivity**, where purchases occur spontaneously but are cognitively framed as necessary, reducing negative emotions afterward. This suggests that regret is not simply the opposite of impulsivity; rather, it depends on how consumers interpret the purchase after the fact. Overall, impulsive buying in this context appears emotionally managed through justification and self-approval.

5. Payment Mechanics & Financial Access

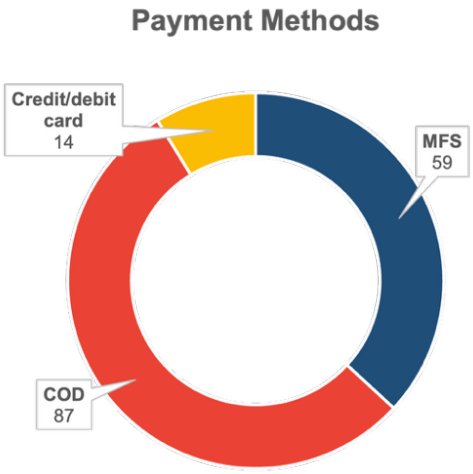
Survey Context

The allowance distribution is fairly spread out, with the largest shares coming from **Below 5,000** and **Above 20,000**, suggesting the dataset includes both budget-conscious buyers and affluent ones. This variation is useful because income-level differences may influence social status motivations and impulse buying tendencies.



Cash-on-delivery remains the most preferred payment method, showing that many buyers still rely on low-commitment purchasing despite the rise of digital payments. Mobile Financial Services also show strong adoption, but cards remain minor. This suggests impulsive fashion buying in Dhaka can still happen even when payment

friction exists (COD), meaning impulsivity may be driven more by **social triggers** than "easy payment convenience" alone.



Hypothesis Testing & Result

Hypothesis 08: This hypothesis aims to find the relationship between preferred payment methods and perceived impulsive buying. The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$\boldsymbol{H_0}: \textit{There is no significant association between preferred payment method and impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers.}$$

$$\boldsymbol{H_A}: \textit{There is a significant association between preferred payment method and impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Gen Z consumers.}$$

As the independent variable (Payment Method) and the dependent variable (Impulsivity Category) are both categorical, a **two-tailed chi-square test of independence** was conducted to examine whether the null hypothesis can be rejected.

Contingency Table (H08)

Payment Method	Low	Medium	High
Cash on Delivery (COD)	56	25	6
Credit/debit card	6	4	4
Mobile financial services (bKash/Nagad/Rocket)	33	16	10

Expected Cell Counts (H08): Chi-square Assumption Check

Payment Method	Low	Medium	High
Cash on Delivery (COD)	51.656	24.469	10.875
Credit/debit card	8.312	3.938	1.750
Mobile financial services (bKash/Nagad/Rocket)	35.031	16.594	7.375

Chi-square Test of Independence (H08): Payment Method & Impulsivity Category

Test	Statistic	df	p-value
Chi-square (Simulated p-value, B = 10000)	7.173		**0.126**

The test reveals that the p-value to be **0.126** which is higher than the α (0.05). So, we ***cannot reject*** the null that *there is no significant association between preferred payment methods and impulsive online fashion buying behavior among Dhaka Gen Z consumers*.

Hypothesis 09: This hypothesis aims to find the relationship between monthly personal allowance/income and impulsive buying. The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$\boldsymbol{H_0}: Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers\ with\ higher\ monthly\ personal\ allowance\ does\ not\ exhibit\ significantly\ higher\ impulsive\ buying\ behavior.$$

$$\boldsymbol{H_A}: Dhaka\ Gen\ Z\ consumers\ with\ higher\ monthly\ personal\ allowance\ exhibits\ significantly\ higher\ impulsive\ buying\ behavior.$$

As the independent variable (Monthly Income/Allowance) is categorical and the dependent variable (Impulsivity) is a numeric composite score, a **one-way ANOVA (two-tailed)** was conducted to test the null hypothesis can be rejected.

Descriptive Statistics (H09)

q3	N	Mean	Std. Deviation
Below 5,000	42	2.595	1.083
5,000–10,000	26	2.519	1.170
10,000–15,000	28	2.250	1.041
15,000–20,000	20	2.700	1.163

q3	N	Mean	Std. Deviation
Above 20,000	44	2.455	1.028

Levene's Test (H09): Homogeneity of Variance

F value	p-value	df	df.residual
0.518	**0.722**	4	155

ANOVA Table (H09): Impulsive Buying Index by Monthly Allowance Group (Q3)

term	df	Sum Sq	Mean Sq	F value	p-value
q3	4	3.030	0.757	0.643	**0.633**
Residuals	155	182.719	1.179		

The test reveals that the p-value to be **0.633** which is higher than the α (0.05). So, we ***cannot reject*** the null that *Dhaka Gen Z consumers with higher monthly personal allowance does not exhibit significantly higher impulsive buying behavior*.

Inference

Findings related to payment methods and monetary access suggest that transaction mechanics function more as contextual constraints than as primary drivers of impulsive buying behavior. The dominance of cash-on-delivery and mobile financial services indicates the presence of payment friction, which may limit the immediacy typically associated with impulsive online consumption.

Rather than enabling impulsive buying through frictionless transactions, these mechanisms appear to introduce an additional decision layer, potentially moderating impulse execution. This suggests that impulsive behavior is more strongly shaped by upstream psychological and cultural triggers than by downstream payment convenience. Consequently, payment methods should be interpreted as situational moderators that shape how impulsive tendencies are expressed, rather than as independent explanatory factors.

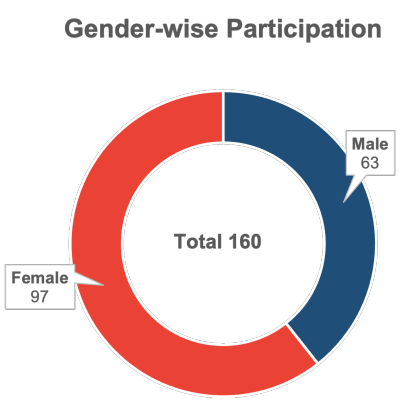
Payment systems and income levels appear to shape the conditions of purchasing rather than directly causing impulsive buying. The ANOVA results indicate no significant differences in impulsive buying across monthly allowance groups, suggesting higher income does not automatically translate into more impulsive online fashion purchases. Qualitative findings reinforce that transaction mechanics

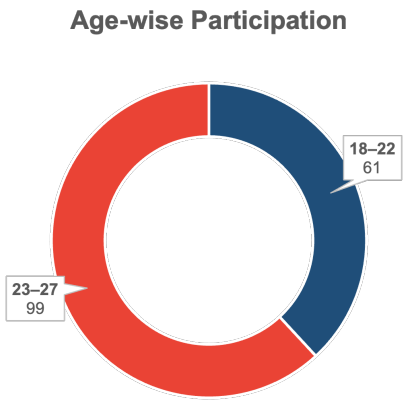
(COD/MFS) introduce friction and an extra decision layer, which may moderate impulse execution rather than enable it. Therefore, payment and monetary access should be interpreted as situational moderators, not primary explanatory drivers.

6. Consumer Heterogeneity & Segmentation

Survey Context

Most respondents fall within the **18–22** age group, meaning the sample is heavily concentrated in early university-age Gen Z consumers, which was the target of this paper. Additionally, the sample contains a higher proportion of **female** respondents, which is relevant given that fashion consumption patterns can differ by gender. This demographic mix provides a strong base for evaluating impulsive fashion buying behavior among Dhaka's student-heavy Gen Z population.





Hypothesis Testing & Results

Hypothesis 10: This hypothesis aims to find the relationship between gender and impulsive buying. The null and alternative hypotheses are:

$$\boldsymbol{H_0}: \textit{There is no significant difference in impulsive online fashion buying behavior between male and female Dhaka Gen Z consumers.}$$

$$\boldsymbol{H_A}: \textit{There is a significant difference in impulsive online fashion buying behavior between male and female Gen Z consumers.}$$

As the independent variable (Gender) is categorical and the dependent variable (Impulsive Buying Index) is a numeric composite score, a **two-tailed independent-samples t-test** (Welch's t-test) was conducted to examine whether the null hypothesis can be rejected.

Descriptive Statistics (H07)

Gender	Mean	Std. Deviation	N
Male	2.77	1.181	63
Female	2.32	0.977	97

t-test Results (H07): Gender Difference in Impulsive Buying

Test	t	df	p	Diff (M-F)	CI Low	CI High
Welch Two-Sample t-test	2.519	114.739	**0.013**	0.45	0.096	0.804

The test reveals that the p-value to be **0.013** which is less than or equal to the α (0.05). So, we can hereby ***reject*** the null that *there is no significant difference in impulsive online fashion buying behavior between male and female Dhaka Gen Z consumers*, i.e., and accept the alternative that *there is a significant difference*.

Qualitative Analysis

Not all respondents conformed to trend-oriented or socially influenced consumption patterns. Some emphasized autonomy, personal values, and identity-based decision-making in their fashion choices, signaling heterogeneity within Gen Z consumption behavior.

"I do wear my outfits that I choose, it doesn't matter if it's trendy or not"

"I love thrifting because sustainability"

These responses highlight a segment of consumers who actively resist mainstream fashion pressures and prioritize self-expression or ethical considerations over trend conformity. Such behavior suggests that impulsive buying is not uniformly experienced across Gen Z but is moderated by individual values and identity orientation. This heterogeneity is important for contextualizing aggregate findings and avoiding overgeneralization, particularly when interpreting gender-based or segmentation-level differences in impulsive buying tendencies.

Inference

Findings show meaningful heterogeneity within Dhaka Gen Z consumers, indicating that impulsive buying is not uniformly experienced across the population. The gender comparison suggests a statistically significant difference in impulsive buying behavior between male and female respondents. At the same time, qualitative evidence

highlights a segment that resists trend pressure and bases consumption on autonomy, sustainability, and identity-based choices. This suggests segmentation variables (gender, values, identity orientation) are important for interpreting aggregate patterns and avoiding overgeneralization about Gen Z impulsivity.

Recommendations & Conclusions

Recommendation

- **Triggering the Rush:** Since internal moods drive buying more than direct peer pressure, the brands/marketers should focus on creating entertaining, mood-lifting content that offers retail therapy and an emotional high (rush of pleasure and excitement).
- **Leveraging Social Belonging:** As friends/peers create a significant pressure to fit in and maintain social status, the brands should use influencers to frame products as status symbols (such that owning the item helps the consumer stand out or belong). Instead of listing features, position items as essential tools for "fitting in" or looking trendy in social circles.
- **Neutralizing Regret:** Since impulsivity often leads to post-purchase guilt, brands should provide immediate post-purchase validation to justify the spend. Automated messages like "Great choice! Here's how to style it" may help reinforce the consumer's decision, reducing the guilt that might otherwise prevent repeat purchases.

Suggestions for Future Research

Future research on this topic should expand the geographical scope beyond Dhaka to include semi-urban and rural areas, providing a more comprehensive national perspective on Gen Z behavior. Additionally, conducting longitudinal studies would allow researchers to track how these impulsive habits evolve over time, overcoming the limitations of a cross-sectional snapshot. Finally, future scholars could incorporate economic variables, such as price sensitivity and inflation, to examine how financial constraints interact with the internal drivers identified in this study.

Conclusion

This study concludes that impulsive fashion buying among Dhaka's Gen Z is driven primarily by internal psychological states rather than external mechanics. The findings reveal that while peer influence indirectly creates social status pressure, the actual decision to purchase is fueled by internal traits and the desire for emotional gratification. Furthermore, the prevalence of post-purchase regret highlights that impulsive consumption is largely a cyclical process of mood regulation that often conflicts with rational financial behavior.

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Appendix

Questionnaire

Part A: Screening & Demographics

Q1. What is your age range?

- Under 18
- 18–22
- 23–27
- 28+

Q2. What is your gender?

- Male
- Female
- Prefer not to say

Q3. What is your monthly personal allowance/income (BDT)?

- Below 5,000
- 5,000–10,000
- 10,001–20,000
- Above 20,000

Q4. What is your preferred method of payment for any sort of purchase—be it fashion item or non-fashion item (please choose one)?

- Cash on Delivery (COD)
- Mobile Financial Services (bKash/Nagad)
- Credit/Debit Card

Part B: Online Shopping Context

Q5. How often do you buy fashion items online?

- Once a week or more
- 2–3 times a month
- Once a month
- Once a couple months
- Rarely

Q6. Which platform do you use MOST often for fashion shopping?

- Facebook (Pages/Marketplace/Live)
- Instagram
- TikTok
- Dedicated brand websites/apps (Daraz, Aarong, etc.)

Please read the statements & select a number from the scale that explains you the best.

Scale: *1 = Strongly disagree … 5 = Strongly agree*

Part C: External Influences (Peer & Status)

Peer Influence

Q7. I discuss fashion purchases with friends or family before buying.

Q8. Seeing my friends post about fashion brands increases my urge to buy.

Q9. Seeing influencers cover certain fashion brands increases my urge to buy that item.

Q10. My friends' approval matters to me when choosing fashion items.

Q11. High engagement (likes/comments/sold-out) makes a product more attractive to me.

Perceived Social Status

Q12. Wearing trendy clothes improves how others perceive me.

Q13. I buy certain fashion brands to signal a higher social status.

Q14. I feel pressure to keep up with fashion trends to fit into my social circle.

Q15. Dressing fashionably makes me feel more confident in social settings (e.g., university, parties).

Part D: Internal Influences (Personality & Hedonics)

Q16. I often buy non-fashion items spontaneously without planning.

Q17. I make quick decisions when shopping online.

Q18. Shopping online improves my mood when I feel stressed or bored.

Q19. I feel excitement or a "rush" when placing an online order.

Q20. I often buy items based on how I feel at the moment.

Q21. The option of “pre-ordering” pushes me to buy more items.

Q22. I enjoy trying new fashion styles, even if they are risky or unconventional.

Part E: Outcome Variables

Q23. How often do you buy items that were not on your original shopping list?

- Never
- Rarely
- Sometimes
- Often
- Very Often

Q24. Have you ever bought an online fashion item that you never used?

- Yes, many times
- Yes, a few times
- No, never

Q25. Have you regretted an online fashion purchase in the last 6 months?

- Yes
- No
- Maybe

Q26. Is there anything else you want to say/comment?

_____

_____

_____